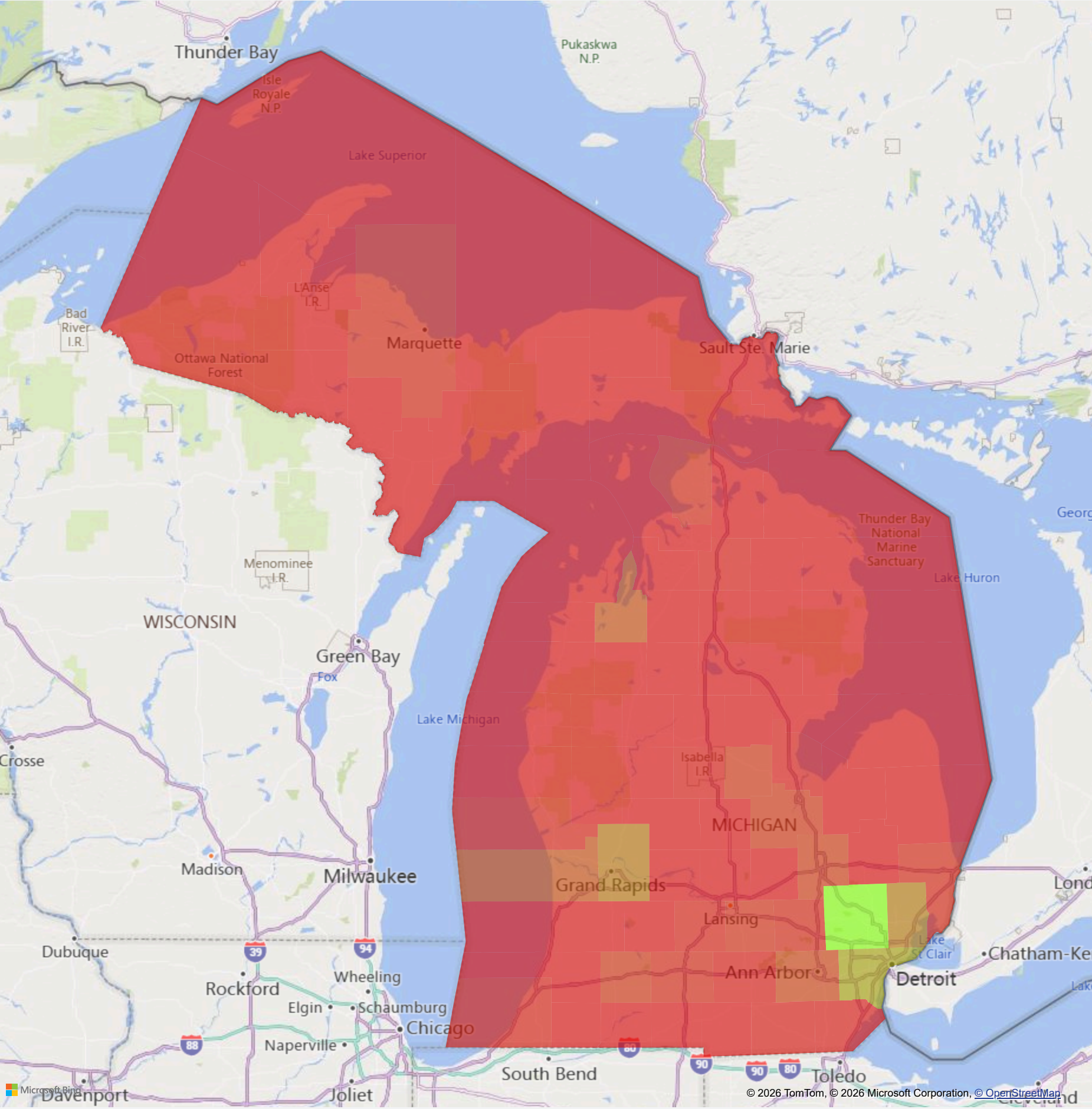
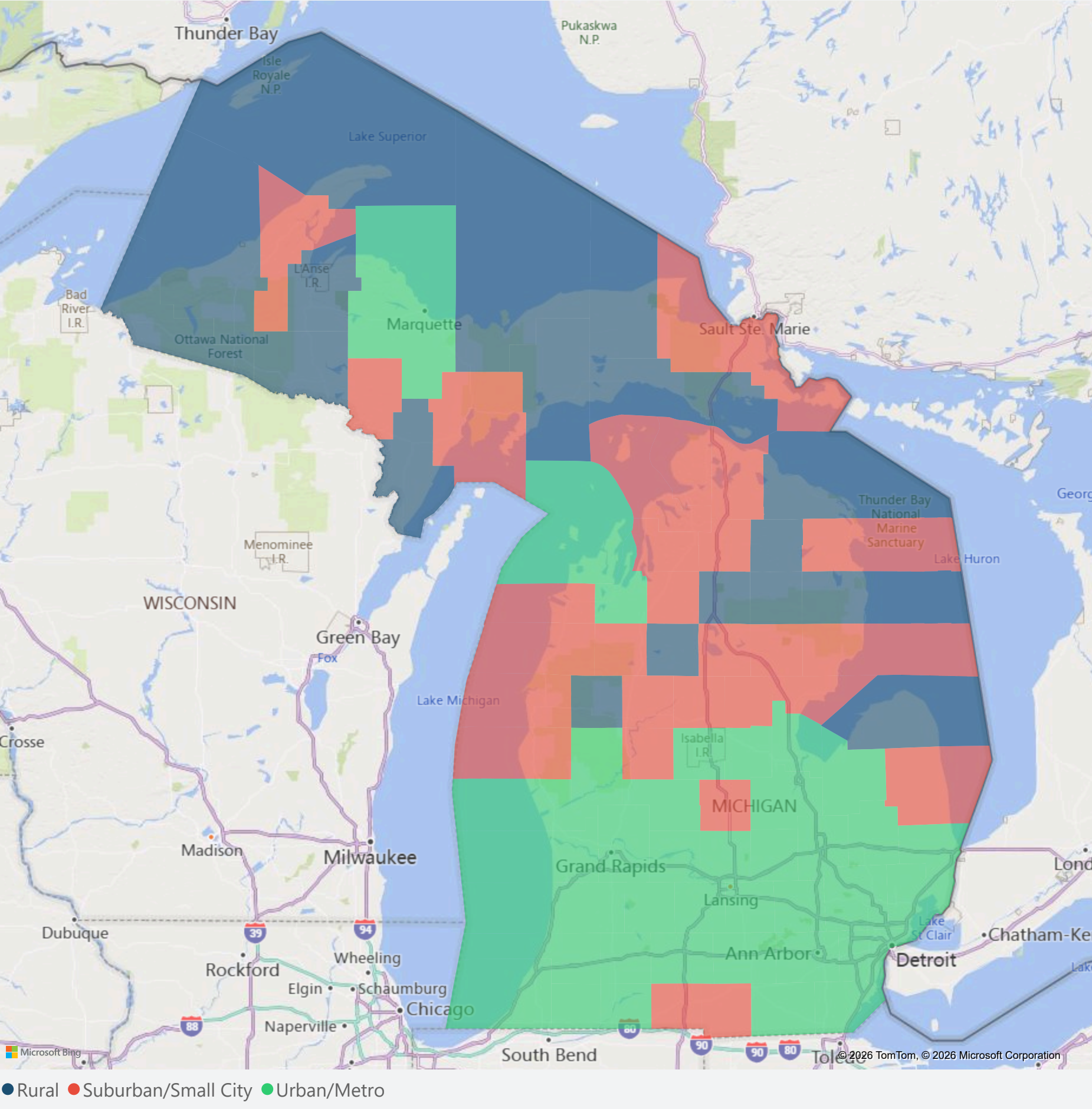


Battery Drop-Off Access by County

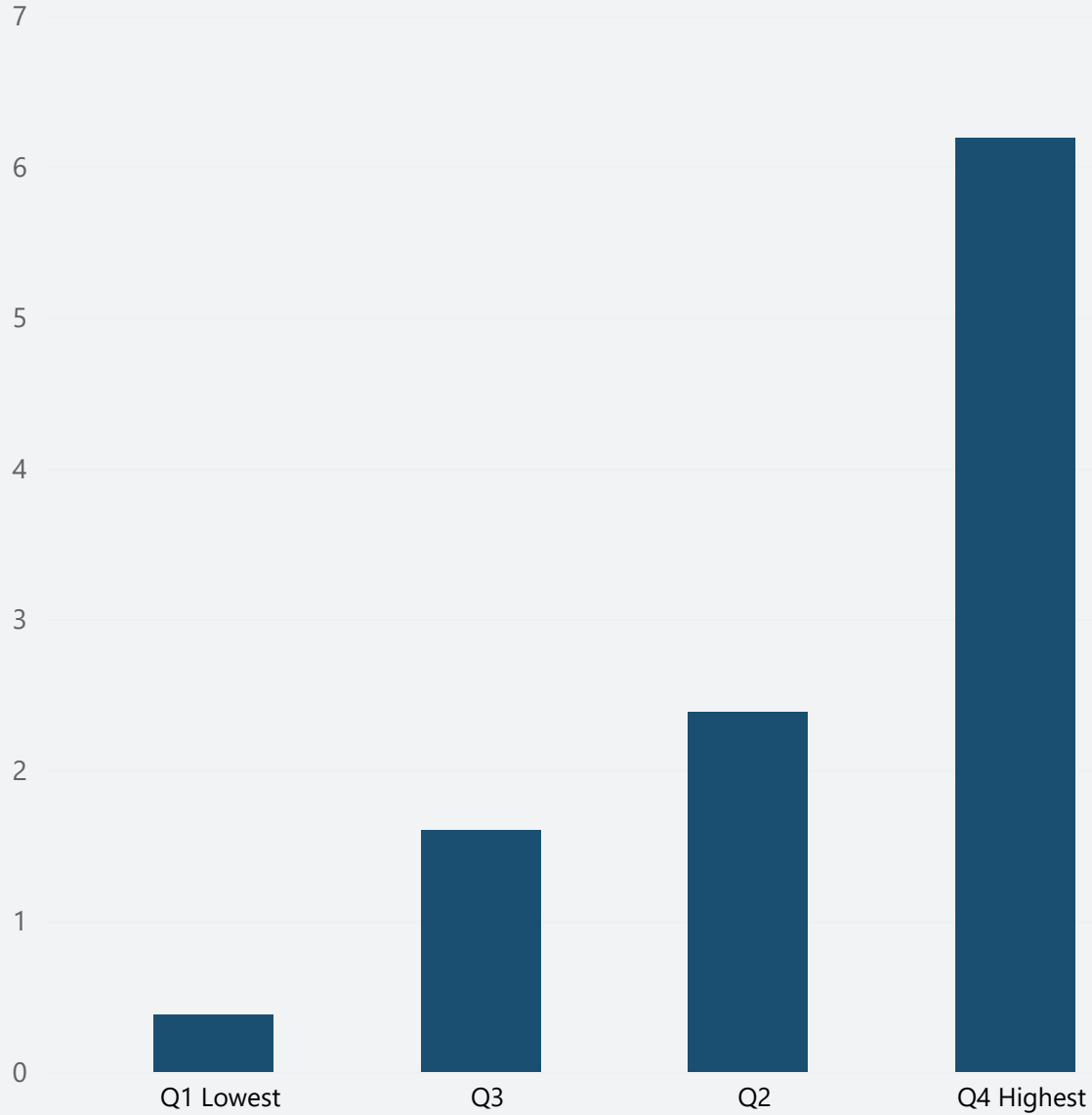


Community Type

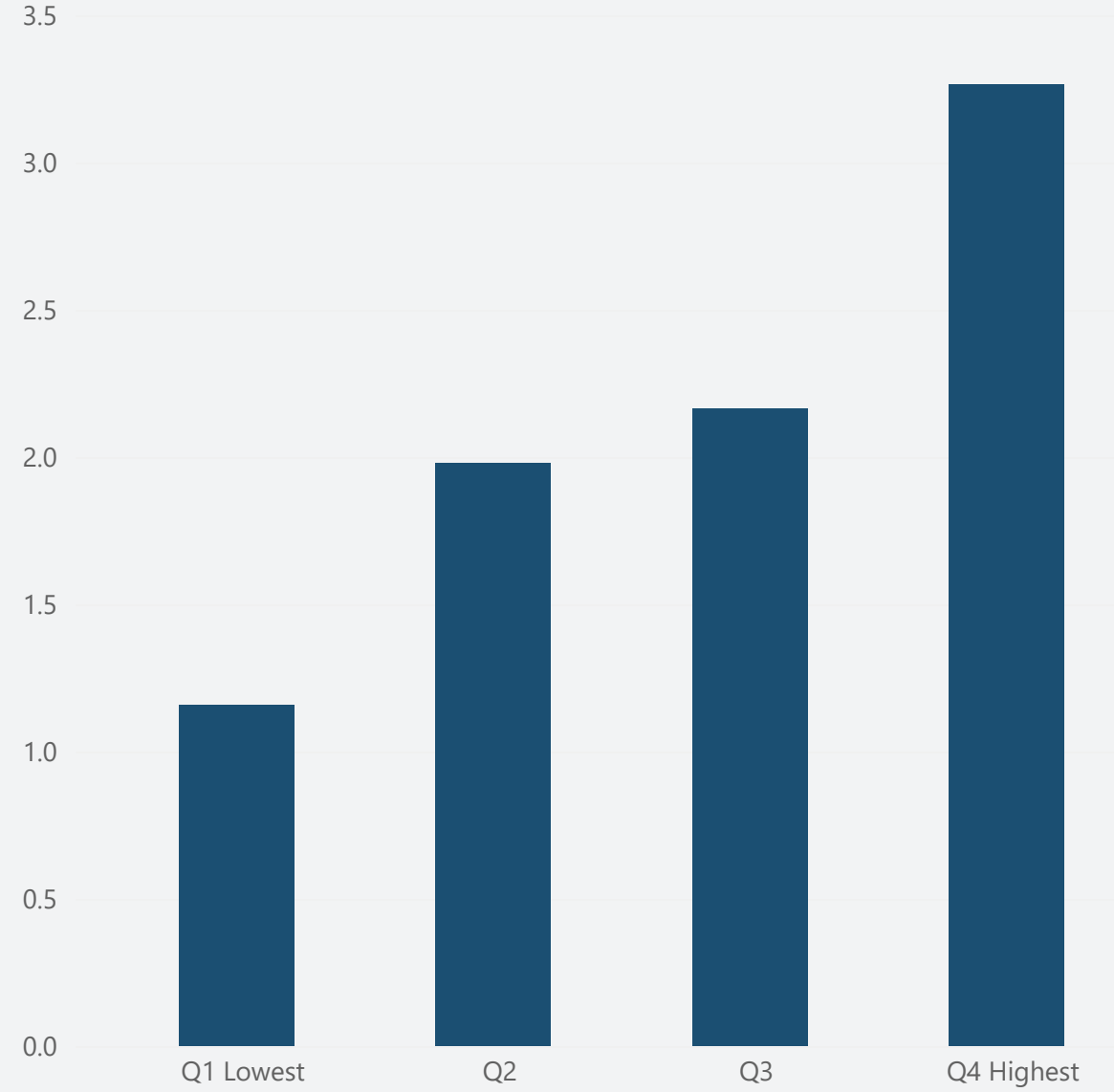


The map on the left shows drop-off site density by county — red means fewer sites, green means more. The map on the right shows community type. The pattern is consistent: rural counties in the north and Upper Peninsula have the least access. Urban and suburban counties in the south have the most. The gap follows both income and geography.

Raw Drop-Off Sites by Income Quartile



Sites per 100k Residents by Income Quartile



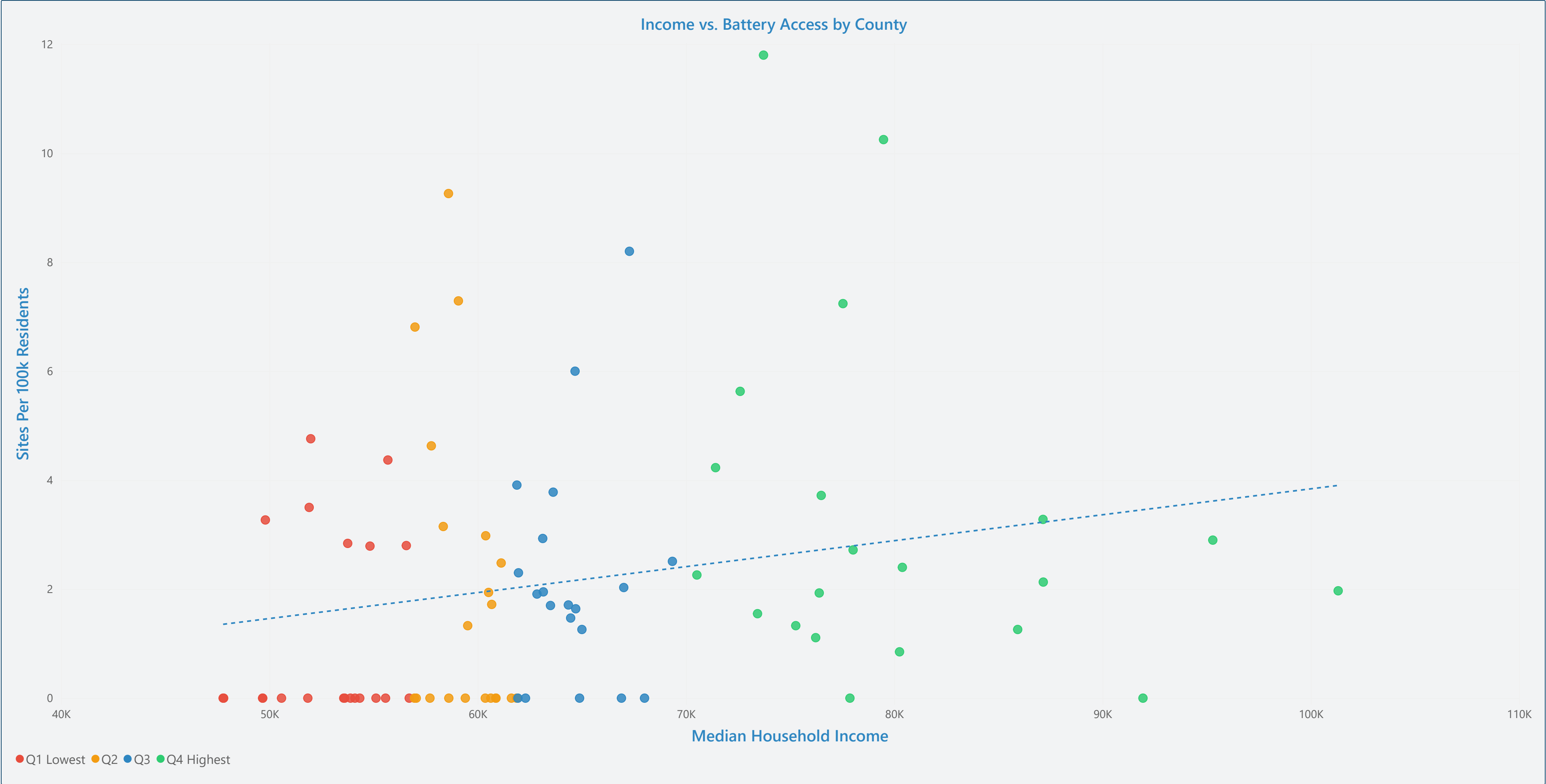
The left chart shows raw drop-off sites by income quartile. Q2 appears higher than Q3 — that is Wayne County inflating the number. Wayne County has 23 sites, but with 1.7 million residents that is only 1.33 sites per 100,000 people — one of the lowest rates in the state. The right chart corrects for population. Q2 drops back below Q3 where it belongs. The lowest income counties average 1.16 sites per 100k residents. The highest average 3.26.

Battery Desert Counties

32 Counties with zero battery drop-off sites

County	Median Household Income	Dropoff Count	Sites Per 100k	Population	Community Type
Iosco	47777	0	0.00	25054	Suburban/Small City
Montmorency	47803	0	0.00	9261	Rural
Gogebic	49672	0	0.00	14526	Rural
Lake	49680	0	0.00	11853	Rural
Oscoda	50581	0	0.00	8241	Rural
Ontonagon	51844	0	0.00	5951	Rural
Alcona	53568	0	0.00	10234	Rural
Iron	53614	0	0.00	11228	Rural
Keweenaw	53893	0	0.00	2103	Rural
Roscommon	54106	0	0.00	23766	Suburban/Small City
Luce	54338	0	0.00	6230	Rural
Baraga	55117	0	0.00	8209	Rural
Gladwin	55576	0	0.00	25289	Suburban/Small City
Presque Isle	56713	0	0.00	12592	Rural
Huron	56963	0	0.00	30981	Rural
Osceola	57050	0	0.00	23460	Suburban/Small City
Schoolcraft	57708	0	0.00	7989	Rural
Crawford	58614	0	0.00	14030	Rural
Alger	59406	0	0.00	9069	Rural
Kalkaska	60365	0	0.00	18038	Suburban/Small City
Chippewa	60631	0	0.00	37354	Suburban/Small City
Hillsdale	60869	0	0.00	45830	Suburban/Small City
Manistee	60879	0	0.00	24397	Suburban/Small City
Cheboygan	61619	0	0.00	26152	Suburban/Small City
Missaukee	61868	0	0.00	15453	Rural
Newaygo	61931	0	0.00	49654	Urban/Metro
Mason	62296	0	0.00	29449	Suburban/Small City
Montcalm	64892	0	0.00	63888	Urban/Metro
Van Buren	66902	0	0.00	76258	Urban/Metro
Cass	68011	0	0.00	51547	Urban/Metro
Barry	77873	0	0.00	61550	Urban/Metro
Leelanau	91943	0	0.00	22355	Urban/Metro

These 32 counties have no battery drop-off sites. They are home to some of Michigan's lowest median household incomes and are disproportionately rural. The residents here are not choosing to throw batteries in the trash — they have no alternative. Food pantries and libraries in these counties are the recommended entry points for site placement.



Each dot represents one Michigan county. The horizontal axis is median household income, the vertical axis is battery drop-off sites per 100,000 residents. The cluster at zero along the bottom are the 32 battery desert counties — nearly all on the left side of the chart in the lowest income ranges. The trend line confirms the correlation: as income increases, access increases. Where retail infrastructure doesn't exist, neither does recycling access.